MAHARASHTRA TOURISM



PANCHWATI GHATS

MAHARASHTRA

THE LAND WHERE THE GODS MEET THEIR DEVOTEES

Maharashtra is not just a land of illustrious temples and holy rivers. It is a place where religion gets simplifies as bhakti, enabling the most common of us to experience the kind of divine presence, about which the most exalted ones rave about. Every deity has a presence here, bestowing their benign grace and blessings to the hoi polloi. A journey through the state is nothing short of a pilgrimage.

An ancient adage states that gods reside where they are celebrated. Guided by a hallowed lineage of saints who simplified religion for the common man, Maharashtra has evolved into a place where gods have preferred to rub shoulders with the faithful, enjoy the pampering of their devotees. In Maharashtra, you can still witness the hallowed traditions that have held strong for centuries, spawning countless stories and experiences.

Lord Vitthal and his consort Rukhmai, the presiding deities of Maharashtra, evoke strong emotions. The month of Aashadhi sees Varkaris, devotees who have dedicated their lives to the god, walking and trekking in groups carrying palanquins of saints and singing bhajans called abhangs, to the shrine in **Pandharpur** from across the state in a journey that might take upto 21 days. It is something that needs to be experienced once in a lifetime. It stands out as the ultimate definition of bhakti or devotion.



ASHTAVINAYAK, LENYADRI



Tourism is pivotal in realizing PM Narendra Modi's vision of a 5 trillion economy by 2030. Furthermore, it emphasizes the need for green and sustainable tourism, urging collective efforts to make Maharashtra the best global destination. Spiritual tourism is set to be a major growth driver for the development of several temple towns in the state, thanks to government policy support and infrastructure developments. The improvements in infrastructure, such as upgraded roads, flagship trains, and new airports, are expected to attract national and international tourists to these spiritual destinations.

GIRISH MAHAJAN
Minister Of Tourism, Government Of Maharashtra

Maharashtra plays a defining role in the life of Ram. Panchavati on the banks of the river Godavari, in the present day Nashik, is where Ram stayed before Sita got abducted. The Ramayana circuit would be incomplete without